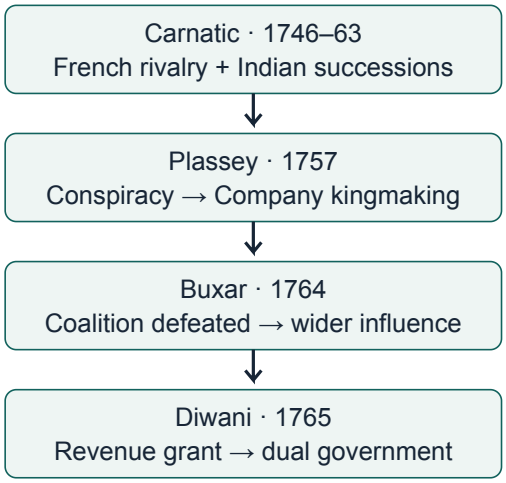
Rise of British Supremacy: Carnatic, Plassey and Buxar

1. Commercial rivalry becomes political power

- Declining effective Mughal authority and regional succession disputes enabled Company intervention. **Trade monopoly, cheaper purchases, protection of settlements and fiscal resources** linked commerce to military power.
- **Carnatic Wars, 1746–63:** English–French struggle centred on the Coromandel Coast; French base **Pondicherry**, English base **Madras**. European wars and local succession conflicts both mattered.
- **Bengal, 1757–65: Plassey → Buxar → diwani** transferred effective power from Nawabs to Company. Southern victories and Bengal resources reinforced each other; conquest was gradual, not completed in 1757.
- Regional powers were active participants with changing interests, not merely passive victims or rulers lacking modern “patriotism”.



Southern rivalry and Bengal revenues jointly advanced Company power.

2. First Carnatic War, 1746–48

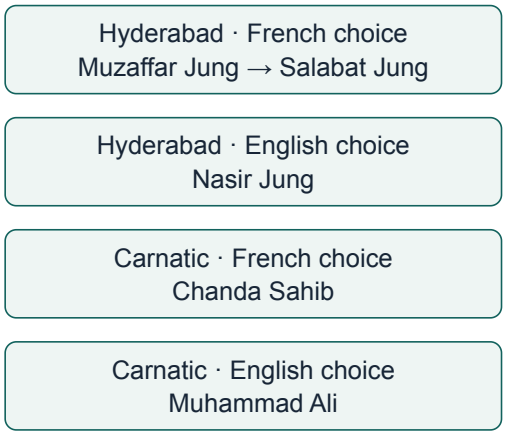
- **Trigger: War of Austrian Succession, 1740–48**; Britain and France on opposing sides. English attacks on French shipping extended hostilities to India despite Dupleix's initial neutrality proposal.
- **Dupleix—French governor, 1742–54**; sought naval aid from **La Bourdonnais, governor of Mauritius**. French captured **Madras/Fort St George, September 1746**; young **Robert Clive** among those caught in the conflict.
- **Anwaruddin, Nawab of Carnatic**, ordered French withdrawal. His son's forces under **Mahfuz Khan** confronted the French near **St Thomé/Mylapore on River Adyar, 1746**.
- **Captain Paradis** led a much smaller French force including Indian soldiers to victory. Lesson: drill, coordination, artillery and command could outweigh numbers; not proof of innate European superiority.
- **Aix-la-Chapelle, 1748:** mutual restitution—**Madras restored to English; Louisbourg in North America restored to French**. No decisive overall winner.

- Dupleix recognised that military support in Indian succession disputes could yield territorial and political concessions.

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3. Second Carnatic War, 1749–54

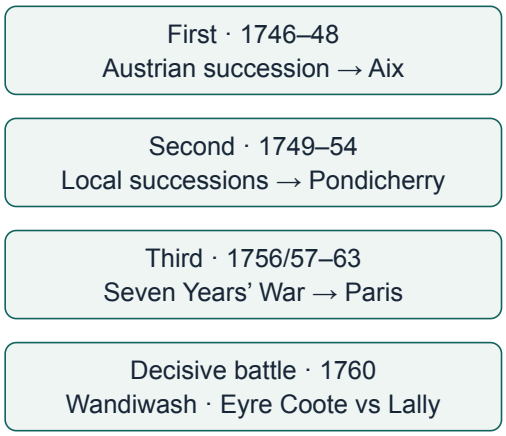
- **Hyderabad:** after **Asaf Jah I/Nizam-ul-Mulk died, 1748**, succession contested by **son Nasir Jung** and **grandson Muzaffar Jung**.
- **Carnatic: Chanda Sahib**, Dost Ali's son-in-law, released from Maratha captivity; challenged **Anwaruddin**, whose son was **Muhammad Ali**.
- **French supported Muzaffar Jung + Chanda Sahib**; **English supported Nasir Jung + Muhammad Ali**. Remember the two linked succession disputes.
- **Ambur, 1749, near Vellore:** French-backed alliance defeated/killed Anwaruddin. Chanda Sahib became Nawab; Muhammad Ali withdrew to **Trichinopoly/Tiruchirappalli**. French received villages near Pondicherry.
- **Nasir Jung killed, 1750 → Muzaffar Jung installed → Muzaffar killed, 1751 → Salabat Jung installed with Bussy's support**. Nasir was killed by an allied Indian chief, not personally by Dupleix.
- **Marquis de Bussy:** maintained French influence at Hyderabad; obtained **four Northern Circars, 1753—Mustafanagar, Ellore, Rajahmundry, Chicacole**. Grants around Pondicherry and **Masulipatnam in present Andhra Pradesh**, not Odisha, strengthened French finances.
- **Clive captures Arcot, August 1751:** diversion to relieve pressure on Muhammad Ali at Trichinopoly; defended it through the subsequent siege. **Kaveripak, 1752**, another English success.
- **Stringer Lawrence relieved Trichinopoly, 1752**; French forces surrendered. Chanda Sahib was killed after falling into **Tanjore/Thanjavur** hands, not by the ruler of Travancore. Muhammad Ali secured the Nawabship.
- **Dupleix recalled, 1754**, amid high war expenses and commercial concerns; **Godeheu** succeeded him.
- **Pondicherry agreement, 1754:** Godeheu and English governor **Saunders** agreed to restrict intervention in Indian rulers' disputes. The supplied text gives 1755; use **1754** for the agreement ending this war. English gained the stronger Carnatic position; Bussy's Hyderabad influence initially survived. INFLIBNET history module



Pair each Company with its candidates in the two succession disputes.

4. Third Carnatic War, 1756/57–63

- **Trigger: Seven Years' War, 1756–63**. Some Indian timelines date the Third Carnatic War from **1757**; learn the European trigger separately.
- **Count de Lally arrived, 1758**; captured **Fort St David**, but siege of Madras failed. Problems: funds/ammunition, naval support, strained relations with officers and local allies.
- **Bussy recalled from Hyderabad** to southern operations; French influence weakened. English forces from Bengal occupied **Rajahmundry/Masulipatnam** and made arrangements with **Salabat Jung**.
- **Wandiwash/Vandavasi, 22 January 1760: Eyre Coote defeated Lally**; **Bussy captured**. Decisive military turning point in English–French rivalry.
- **Pondicherry surrendered, 16 January 1761**; French sought Mysorean help, but it did not reverse the outcome. Other positions, including **Gingee and Mahe**, also fell.
- **Paris, 1763:** French settlements restored for commerce under restrictions; ambitions for territorial supremacy curtailed. French presence continued—the treaty did not expel every French trader from India.
- **Lally executed in France, 1766**, after prosecution for the defeat.



Three wars: trigger, settlement and decisive battle.

5. Why the English defeated the French

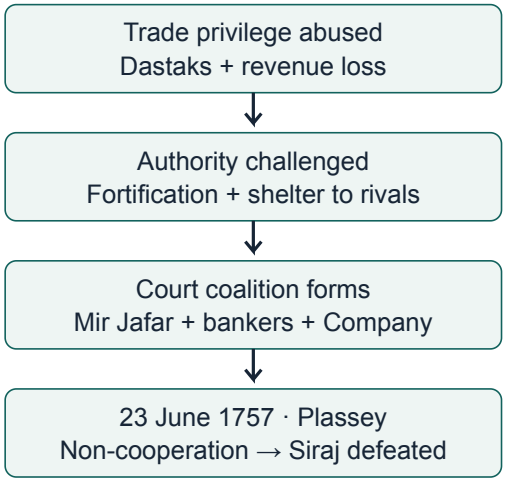
- **Naval superiority:** more reliable reinforcements, shipping and control of sea communications; French support intermittent.
- **Finance and commerce:** stronger English commercial networks/credit; **Bengal wealth after Plassey** financed southern campaigning. French finances strained by continental wars and expensive intervention.
- **Organisation:** French Company more dependent on royal sponsorship; English directors pursued commercial interests with greater operational autonomy. English Company still depended on British naval/State support—"wholly independent of State" is inaccurate.
- **Leadership and coordination:** Dupleix's recall, withdrawal of Bussy and Lally's conflicts weakened continuity; English commanders and Indian allies coordinated more effectively at decisive moments.
- **European priorities:** France's continental commitments diverted resources, while Britain emphasised maritime/colonial competition. Avoid absolute claims that Britain had no European interests or that French political institutions alone caused defeat.
- **Mains balance:** explain interacting finance, logistics, diplomacy and leadership; Bengal access was crucial, not a single universal explanation.

6. Bengal before Plassey

- **Hugli factory, 1651—Shah Shuja**; other factories at **Kasimbazar and Patna**. **1698:** Company acquired zamindari of **Sutanuti, Kalikata, Gobindapur**; Bengal administration centred on **Fort William around 1700**.
- **1717 Farrukhsiyar farman:** Company trading concessions; **₹3,000 annual Bengal payment**. **Dastaks**, intended for entitled Company goods, were misused in servants' private trade; revenue loss and unequal competition provoked Nawabs.
- **Murshid Quli Khan:** combined provincial/revenue authority in **1717**. **Alivardi Khan, 1740–56:** restrained European fortification; grandson **Siraj-ud-Daulah succeeded, April 1756**.
- Bengal supplied textiles/silk and other valuable exports; merchant-bankers and landed interests influenced provincial politics. “Independent” Nawabs retained formal imperial connections.

7. Siraj–Company conflict and the Plassey conspiracy

- **Court rivals: Shaukat Jung, Purnea**, and **Ghaseti Begum**; factions involving **Jagat Seths, Mir Jafar, Rai Durlabh, Raj Ballabh, Umichand/Amir Chand**, and others weakened Siraj's position.
- Company provocations: **dastak abuse; unauthorised Fort William fortification; shelter to Krishna Das, Raj Ballabh's son; political support to Siraj's rivals**.
- **Fort William fell, 20 June 1756**; governor **Roger Drake** fled to **Fulta/Falta**. Siraj renamed Calcutta **Alinagar**; **Manik Chand** placed in charge.
- **“Black Hole” account: J. Z. Holwell** claimed confinement of 146 people with only 23 survivors. Numbers, circumstances and Siraj's direct responsibility are disputed; do not memorise the narrative as uncontested evidence. It became a justification for British aggression.
- English expedition from Madras under **Clive**, with naval support under **Admiral Charles Watson**, recovered Calcutta **January 1757**.
- **Treaty of Alinagar, 9 February 1757:** restored commercial privileges, permitted fortification and provided compensation. It did not end Company's plans for a change of Nawab.
- Company and disaffected court interests arranged **Mir Jafar's installation**. Other participants included **Manik Chand, Jagat Seths and Khadim Khan**; roles and motives varied. French **Chandernagore captured, March 1757**, weakened a potential rival.



Commercial dispute and court factionalism converged in the Plassey conspiracy.

8. Plassey, 23 June 1757: conspiracy and consequence

- **Location:** Palashi/Plassey on Bhagirathi in Bengal. **Clive's Company forces versus Siraj's much larger army**; Company army itself included many Indian sepoys.
- **Mir Madan and Mohan Lal resisted**; Mir Madan killed. **Mir Jafar and Rai Durlabh withheld effective support**; Siraj withdrew and his position collapsed.
- Siraj later captured and killed on orders associated with **Miran, Mir Jafar's son**; **Muhammad Ali Beg** identified as the killer in the supplied account.
- **Mir Jafar installed, 1757**; Company received **24-Parganas zamindari**, commercial privileges, compensation and large payments/gifts to officials. Separate payments to Company and individuals—do not treat every quoted gift as the whole settlement.
- Company became **kingmaker**; resident **William Watts** and a Company military presence strengthened influence. **Clive's first Bengal governorship is conventionally dated 1758–60**; political ascendancy began with Plassey in 1757.
- **Significance:** limited fighting produced enormous political/fiscal consequences. Wealth/credit financed southern wars and expansion; merchants' commercial power acquired a territorial base.
- **Plassey did not itself grant diwani**; the imperial revenue grant followed **1765**. Private-trade abuses also did not become universally lawful simply through victory.
- Interpretation associated with **K. M. Panikkar:** collaboration of financiers and commanders was central. Explain interests and institutions beyond Siraj's personality or “treachery” alone.

9. Mir Jafar to Mir Qasim

- **Mir Jafar, 1757–60:** faced unpaid forces, local opposition and Company's escalating demands; sought Dutch support. **Bedara/Biderra, November 1759:** English defeated Dutch intervention.
- **Henry Vansittart succeeded Clive, 1760**. Company replaced Jafar with son-in-law **Mir Qasim, October 1760**, expecting greater payments.
- **Mir Qasim, 1760–63:** ceded **Burdwan, Midnapore and Chittagong**; promised share in **Sylhet chunam/lime trade**; paid large gifts to Company officials.
- Reforms: capital **Murshidabad** → **Monghyr/Munger**; bureaucracy/revenue reorganisation; European-style military training and gun manufacture. Sought effective provincial autonomy within existing political arrangements.
- Conflict with **Ram Narayan, Bihar deputy**, backed by English interests; Qasim removed him. His execution belongs to the later conflict, not proof of a separate sovereign Bihar kingdom.
- **Private-trade abuses:** sold/misused dastaks, coercive purchases and duty evasion → Nawab's revenue loss + Indian merchants' disadvantage.
- **Vansittart–Qasim compromise, 1762:** private inland trade to pay **9% duty** and respect Nawab's authority; rejected by Calcutta Council, whose members benefited from private trade.
- **Qasim abolished inland duties, 1763**, giving Indian merchants parity. Company's **Ellis attacked Patna**; war followed. Qasim defeated and fled to Awadh.
- **Mir Jafar restored, 1763–65**, before Buxar—not first restored after Buxar. **Ghulam Husain's Siyar-ul-Mutakhkherin** valued Qasim's administration; historical assessment should distinguish reform from the violent war.



Correct sequence of Nawabs during the transfer of Bengal's effective power.

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10. Buxar, 22 October 1764

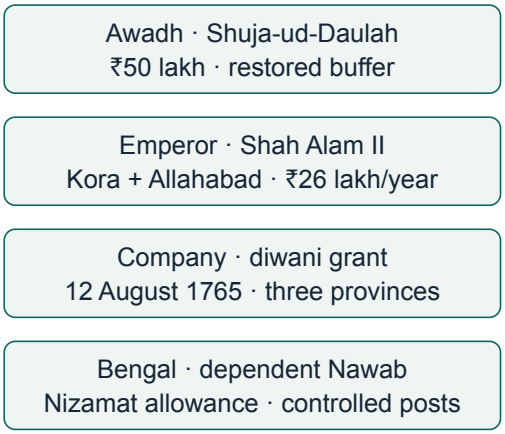
- **Allied powers: Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daulah, Nawab of Awadh + Shah Alam II, Mughal emperor**. **Company commander: Hector Munro**—not Clive.
- Trade/revenue conflict escalated into a wider regional confrontation. Mir Qasim's alliance is central; he had fallen out with Shuja and was no longer personally directing the allied battlefield army.
- Company victory in substantial, contested fighting confirmed its military strength; command, cohesion and disciplined forces mattered more than numbers alone.
- **Plassey:** opened Bengal through conspiracy/court intervention. **Buxar:** defeated a broader coalition, extended Company influence into north India and enabled the **1765 settlements**.
- Bengal Nawab dependent; Awadh at Company's mercy; emperor negotiated under protection. Victory did not mean immediate annexation of all three powers.

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11. Allahabad settlements and diwani, 1765

- **Clive's second governorship, 1765–67**; defined Company's relations with defeated powers.
- **Awadh settlement, 16 August 1765: Shuja-ud-Daulah** paid **₹50 lakh indemnity**; surrendered **Kora and Allahabad** for emperor; **Balwant Singh of Banaras** confirmed in his estate; Company protection/troop arrangements increased dependence.
- **Awadh restored as buffer**, avoiding an exposed direct Company frontier towards Maratha/Afghan powers. This precedes Wellesley's later standard subsidiary-alliance system.
- **Imperial diwani grant, 12 August 1765: Bengal, Bihar and Orissa** revenues to Company; **₹26 lakh annually to Shah Alam II**; emperor received Kora/Allahabad and protection. NIOS: Bengal settlement
- "Orissa" refers to the imperial provincial grant, not immediate Company acquisition of all modern Odisha; coastal Cuttack remained outside effective Company possession until **1803**.
- **Najm-ud-Daulah succeeded Mir Jafar, February 1765**. Nawab's defence/foreign relations and control over appointments came under Company; administration handled through a **naib-subahdar** acceptable to it.

- Initial allowance for Nawab's nizamat expenses approximately **₹53 lakh annually**; Company obtained legal revenue authority while already exercising practical political control.

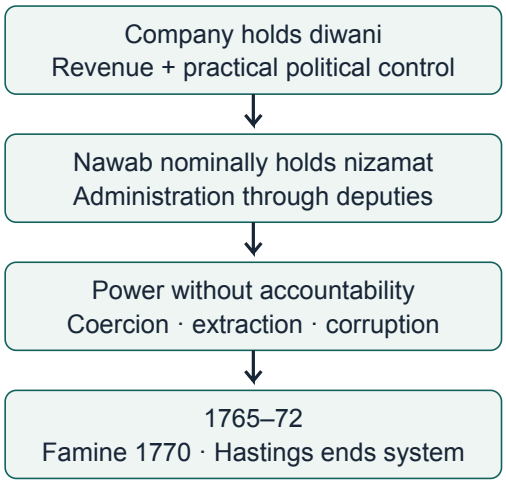


Distinguish the defeated powers and their separate settlements.

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12. Dual government in Bengal, 1765–72

- **Diwani:** revenue/financial functions—Company. **Nizamat:** executive, policing/criminal justice—nominal Nawab. **Reality: Company controlled both through dependent intermediaries**, retaining power while shifting administrative responsibility.
- **Muhammad Reza Khan:** deputy diwan in Bengal, also naib-nazim; **Raja Shitab Roy:** Bihar deputy diwan. Existing Indian machinery collected revenue under Company direction.
- Clive's reasons: maximise commercial revenue; avoid full administrative cost/personnel burden; retain a familiar Nawab façade; reduce resistance by Indian/European powers and scrutiny from Britain.
- Consequences: weak accountability, oppressive revenue extraction, corruption and coercive trade; peasants and artisans carried the burden.
- **Drain mechanism:** Bengal revenues purchased Indian goods for overseas sale, replacing bullion remittances from Britain. Company political power also enforced unfavourable prices/monopolistic buying.
- Raw-silk encouragement versus restrictions on woven-silk production favoured British industry. Claims of systematic Company cutting of weavers' thumbs are not established facts; coercion itself is well documented.
- **Bengal famine, 1770:** crop failure/drought compounded by extraction, commerce and administrative failures; avoid attributing it to only one cause.
- **Warren Hastings ended dual government, 1772**, bringing revenue management more directly under Company. This eighteenth-century arrangement is distinct from constitutional **dyarchy introduced in 1919**.



Formal division concealed the concentration of effective Company power.

13. PYQ recall and Mains structure

- **1995:** correctly matched **Wandiwash—French versus East India Company** → **(b)**. Buxar—Munro versus allied coalition; Chillianwala—Sikhs, 1849; Kharda—Marathas versus Nizam, 1795.
- **1996:** first European associated with systematic succession intervention for territorial gain—**Dupleix** → **(b)**.
- **2004:** only **Mir Jafar's Plassey conspiracy** correct → **3 only, (b)**. Ibrahim Lodi died in **First Panipat, 1526**; Third Panipat **1761**, Abdali versus Marathas; Tipu died in **Fourth Mysore War, 1799**.
- **2005 chronology: Ambur 1749 → Plassey 1757 → Wandiwash 1760 → Buxar 1764 → (b)**.
- **Mains framework:** commercial interests + regional court coalitions → Plassey kingmaking → revenue/trade conflict under Qasim → Buxar military confirmation → diwani/dual government → expansion and economic extraction. Distinguish political turning point from legal revenue grant.